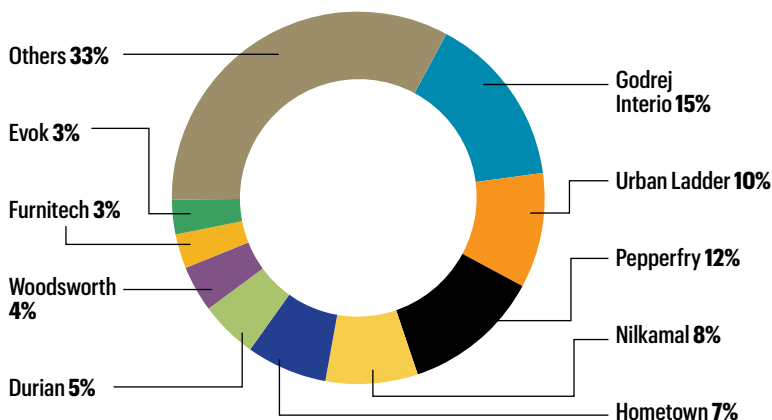


LEADERBOARD

- In India, Godrej Interio is the leader in the furniture sector
- Companies have more space to grow since the unorganised sector still controls a significant portion of the industry



DATA AS OF JULY 31, 2024 **SOURCE** INDUSTRY REPORTS, MARKETWATCH, INDIA RETAILING

of everything, from the modular kitchen to the drawing room, from cupboards to beds,” Sarkar says.

Hussaine Kesury, Chief Business Officer at furniture retailer Pepperfry, has a similar philosophy. Unlike the quiet elegance of Poltrona Frau, Pepperfry’s world is a whirlwind of styles and designs. “We offer something for everyone,” says Kesury, adding that Pepperfry’s approach is all about curation and accessibility. “We keep a close watch on global design trends and introduce innovative pieces that stand out,” he explains. Starting primarily as an e-commerce company that had furniture at its core, Pepperfry has become one of the country’s leading companies that houses over 500 home-grown and international brands, with a selection that is both diverse and comprehensive.

But it’s not just about variety, Kesury says. “We view our partners as collaborators, not competitors,” he explains, highlighting its unique marketplace approach.

In addition, Pepperfry’s transition from an online platform to an omnichannel presence with over 150 studios in more than 90 cities has been a game-changer. “Our experience studios allow customers to touch and feel the products, get expert advice, and make informed decisions,” says Kesury. This tactile experience is crucial in a market where furniture purchases are family decisions, often taking weeks to finalise.

Coming back to Poltrona, Coropulis understands that one of the ways to penetrate deeper into the Indian market is to embrace local styles and aesthetics. “When I sit down with my distributors, this is

exactly what we discuss,” he says.

But if, for global brands, understanding the hyperlocal sensibilities present in India might be a challenge—certainly not insurmountable by any means—this is counted as a strength for a company like Godrej. Sarkar explains that India is such a market where every region has its own unique demands, its own unique aesthetics, needs, and so on. “That’s why I am travelling non-stop. Because I want to go to as many markets as possible. It is imperative that we understand these local dynamics and weave them into our business strategy,” he says.

Adding to this is the omnichannel strategy. “Today we have a website that lists all of our products... [and] even provides facilities for visual searches,” Sarkar says. With a robust network of 970 showrooms and 27 branches across India, the company is “servicing 17,200 PIN codes in India,” Sarkar mentions, showcasing the brand’s extensive reach.

The current state of the Indian furniture market is quite fascinating, with both local heritage brands and global luxury giants competing for the customer’s wallet. The entry of global brands like Poltrona Frau, Pottery Barn and others highlights the potential for international brands to carve a niche by blending their unique design philosophies with local aesthetics. Meanwhile, major Indian brands such as Godrej and Pepperfry are not just holding their ground but innovating to meet the changing needs of their customers. As these brands continue to evolve and adapt, the future of the Indian furniture market promises to be as diverse and vibrant as the country itself. **BT**

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